Haitian (Daniel) Zhu

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Education

University of Illinois Chicago Chicago, IL
B.S. in Computer Science Expected May 2027
Honors: Dean's List (Spring 2026) | **Certification:** App Development with Swift Associate (Apple, Dec 2025)
Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Software Design, Software Engineering, Database Systems, Computer Systems, Programming Language Design & Implementation

Technical Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Dart, Java, Python, SQL, Swift, C, C++
Frameworks & Data: React Native, Flutter, Node.js, Fastify, SQLite, Supabase (PostgreSQL), WebSockets
Developer Tools: Git, GitHub Actions, Jest, JUnit, Xcode, Maven, Claude Code, OpenAI Codex

Selected Projects

OnlyPlanes - Real-Time Flight Tracking App Apr 2026 - Present
Primary Engineer | React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Fastify, SQLite

- Built an iOS/Android flight-tracking app and Fastify backend in a TypeScript monorepo, sharing typed contracts across the mobile app, API, and admin console.
- Delivered viewport-filtered WebSocket updates with timestamp-based position interpolation; coalesced overlapping map requests to limit upstream polling to active viewing regions.
- Implemented quota-aware provider failover and bounded per-client send queues; added Jest regression tests for backpressure, provider failover, and viewport scheduling.
- Ran Claude Code and Codex agents on feature branches merged via PRs with CI; added a hook that blocks destructive shell commands, read-only audit subagents, and cross-model code review that re-verifies fixes with regression tests.

Workout Movement Tracker Jan 2026 - May 2026
Team Lead | Flutter, Dart, SQLite, Gemini API, ML Kit

- Led a 4-person team building a Flutter workout and nutrition tracker with ML Kit pose detection and HealthKit/Health Connect integration.
- Built the SQLite data layer with repositories and versioned schema migrations; integrated USDA FoodData Central food search with 500 ms debounce, stale-response discarding, and SQLite-backed result caching.
- Integrated Gemini coaching for workouts, diet, and goals; cached responses by input fingerprint to skip repeat API calls.

Networked 3-Card Poker Game Nov 2025
Course Project, CS 342 Software Design | Java, JavaFX, TCP Sockets, JUnit

- Built a thread-per-client TCP server for up to 8 JavaFX clients; wrote 17 JUnit tests for hand rankings and payouts.

Experience

Handshake AI Fellowship May 2026 - Oct 2026
AI Output Evaluator (Contract) | Remote

- Evaluated AI-generated images and web interfaces against task-specific rubrics for instruction adherence, visual quality, and functionality.
- Tested interface interactions, documented usability and functional defects, and assigned comparative ratings with evidence-based written feedback.